Your Husband's Care Changes in a Few Days: Three Things to Work Out First

Who will be there, which hours are open, and what goes to the care team.

There's a date for your husband's move, and everyone has said they'll pitch in. What nobody has said yet is which days, which hours, or who is there at night.

Three things come first, and they go in this order.

1 Write out who will be there

Start with what he'll need a hand with. Medicare's discharge checklist asks families to mark the everyday activities that need help, such as bathing, dressing, using the bathroom, stairs, meals and getting to appointments. Then take one ordinary day, early morning through overnight, and write beside each part of it who has told you they'll be there, with the day and the time they gave you. “I'll help” goes on a separate line until it has both. [1]

WHY THIS COMES FIRST Until each offer sits beside an hour, nobody can see what the plan is resting on, including the people who made the offers.

2 Mark the hours with no name beside them

Go back over the page and mark every stretch with nobody in it, and every stretch where the only name is yours. Look at the night, the first hour of the morning and the handoffs, when one person leaves before the next arrives. The Family Caregiver Alliance suggests a question to take to the discharge team: does he need help at night and, if so, how will I get enough sleep? [2]

WHY THIS COMES FIRST An open hour on paper is something you can ask about. It isn't a verdict on the plan.

3 Take the safety questions to the care team

Write each worry about falls, his medicines, time on his own or the place he's going as a question, not an answer. Medicare's checklist says to write your questions down and discuss them with the staff: the doctor, the discharge planner, the social worker or the nurse. Beside each question, note who you gave it to. [1]

WHY THIS COMES FIRST These questions need someone who has assessed him. Your part is to make sure each one gets asked.

What can wait until later

- A schedule for the whole month. One ordinary day and the first week are enough to begin with.
- Who in the family does what in the long run.
- Changes to the house, or equipment. Write down what you've noticed and ask about it; what's needed is for the people who assess him to say.
- What the open hours mean. That takes someone who knows what he needs, and your page is what makes that conversation a good one.

If something can't sit on a list

A worry that is on your mind today doesn't have to wait for the page to be finished. Medicare's checklist tells families to write down the names and phone numbers of people to call with questions or concerns. If nobody gave you a number, ask for one. And if the week feels hurried, the Family Caregiver Alliance says it is reasonable to ask the discharge planning team to slow things down so nothing is overlooked.

What this guide doesn't do

It doesn't interpret the discharge papers, say whether the arrangement is safe, or decide anything about your husband's care. It puts the next few days in order.

Ready for the next step?

You've put the offers beside the hours, marked the open ones and written your questions for the care team. The care interview takes it from there: it asks about your husband's situation area by area, his safety and the people helping included, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The everyday activities to mark, and the advice to write questions down and take them to the staff, follow Medicare's discharge checklist. The question about nights, and the line about asking the team to slow down, are the Family Caregiver Alliance's. The map of the day and the order of the three moves are ours.

1. Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services, Your Discharge Planning Checklist (CMS Product No. 11376)
2. Family Caregiver Alliance, Hospital Discharge Planning: A Guide for Families and Caregivers

From the Family Care Roadmap · Richard Ladson, Certified Medicaid Planner. Draft for review, generated 2026-10-04.